

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm&IdeaPrioritizationTemplate

Date	3July2026
Project Name	SmartLibraryRequestWorkflowusingServiceNow

Step1:TeamGathering,Collaboration&SelecttheProblemStatement

TeamDiscussionSummary

The team discussed the challenges faced in managing library operations, including manual borrow request handling, poor visibility into book availability, time-consuming approvals, and lack of centralized reporting. Current processes rely on paper forms, spreadsheets, or disconnected systems, leading to delays, duplicate requests, and inaccurate book status tracking. After evaluating different approaches, the team selected Smart Library Request Workflow using ServiceNow as the best solution because it centralizes all library operations, automates request handling and approvals, maintains real-time book status, enforces role-based access control, and provides actionable insights through reporting and dashboards. ServiceNow enables the library to reduce manual effort, improve accuracy, and enhance the experience for both students and librarians.

Step2:Brainstorm,IdeaListing&Grouping

Brainstormed Ideas

Book Management

- Create and maintain book catalog with details (ISBN, Title, Author, Edition).
- Track book status (Available, Issued, Lost, Returned, Damaged).
- Bulk book upload via import.
- Book availability dashboard for quick lookup.

Borrow Requests

- Student self-service borrow request creation.
- Request status tracking for students.
- Multiple request handling per student.
- Request cancellation by student. **Workflow Automation**
- Manager/Librarian approval workflow.
- Automatic book status update on approval.
- Automatic status revert on rejection.
- SLA tracking for request processing.

TaskManagement

- Automatic taskcreationforlibrariansonapproval.
- Taskassignmentbased onrequest type.
- Taskcompletiontracking.

Role-BasedAccessControl

- Studentrolewithlimitedaccesstoownrequests.
- Librarianrolewithfullsystemaccess.
- Administratorroleforsystemconfiguration.
- MostBorrowed Booksreport.
- Requestapprovalratereport.
- Overduebooksreport.
- Studentborrowing history report.
- Library usagedashboard.
- SLAcompliancedashboard.

Reporting&Analytics

Notifications&Communication

- Emailnotificationonrequestapproval.
- Emailnotificationonrequestrejection.
- Reminderemailforduedates.
- In-appnotifications.

FutureEnhancements

- Integrationwithexternallibrarycatalog.
- Barcodescanningforbookcheck-in/check-out.
- Mobileappforstudentrequests.
- Overduedefinecalculation.
- Multi-librarysupport.

Step3:IdeaPrioritization

Idea	Priority	Selected
BookCatalog&StatusTracking	High	✓
StudentSelf-ServiceRequests	High	✓
LibrarianApprovalWorkflow	High	✓
AutomaticStatusUpdates	High	✓

Role-BasedAccessControl	High	✓
TaskCreation&Assignment	High	✓
SLATracking	High	✓
MostBorrowedBooksReport	Medium	✓
RequestApprovalRateReport	Medium	✓
LibraryUsageDashboard	Medium	✓
EmailNotifications	Medium	✓
OverdueBooksReport	Medium	✓
BarcodeScanning	Low	Future
MobileApp	Low	Future
Multi-LibrarySupport	Low	Future
FineCalculationEngine	Low	Future

FinalSelectedIdea

Develop a Smart Library Request Workflow in ServiceNow that includes a centralized book catalog with real-time status tracking, self-service student borrow requests, librarian approval workflows with automatic book status updates, task management for request fulfillment, role-based access control for students and librarians, SLA tracking for approval timelines, comprehensive reporting on library usage trends and borrowing patterns, and notification system for request status updates. This solution will be built using ServiceNow's Service Catalog, Flow Designer, custom tables for book and request management, ACLs for role-based access, and reporting dashboards. Future enhancements may include barcode scanning, mobile app support, multi-library scalability, and fine calculation capabilities.